Sheikh Arsalan-ul-Haque

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Education

University of Delaware — Newark, DE
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics — *Expected May 2027*
Advisor: Adrienne Lucas. **Committee:** Sabrin Beg and Maria Rosales-Rueda. **External member:** Kate Vyborny.

University of Delaware — Newark, DE
M.S. in Economics and Applied Econometrics — *June 2025*

Lahore University of Management Sciences — Lahore, Pakistan
B.Sc. (Honors) in Economics and Mathematics — *June 2021*
GPA: 3.75/4.00; graduated with distinction.

Research Interests

Development Economics; Gender and Family Economics; Health Economics; Labor Economics.

Working Papers

- **Unilateral Divorce and the Marriage Market: Evidence from India's Triple Talaq Ban**
  [Job Market Paper] (with Rounak Bose)
  Abstract. Divorce reform can affect whether existing marriages survive, who enters marriage, and outcomes within newly formed marriages. We study India's ban and September 2018 criminalization of triple talaq, an instantaneous form of divorce historically available to Muslim husbands. Using nationally representative surveys and marriage histories, we compare changes among Muslim women with those among non-Muslim women in a difference-in-differences framework. Among marriages formed before the reform, formal divorce declines, and the composition of surviving marriages shifts toward women who married at ages 12–17 and toward couples with husbands at least five years older. Women in these marriages also report less say over their husbands' earnings. Turning to marriage formation, entry into first marriage declines most clearly among girls aged 12–17 who have not completed primary school. Together, these patterns suggest that restricting husbands' unilateral exit may increase the survival of existing marriages involving vulnerable women while making prospective husbands less willing to marry them. Before marriage, husbands can avoid the future exit restriction by declining to marry. Among marriages formed after the reform, we find lower divorce and suggestive evidence of increased participation in household decisions and reduced emotional intimate partner violence. These findings are consistent with greater commitment within newly formed marriages.
- **Intended and Unintended Consequences of a De Facto Inheritance Reform** *(with Sabrin Beg, Erica Field, Kate Vyborny, Suzanna Khalifa, and Jeremy Lebow)*
  Studies the effects of Punjab's land-record digitization on women's inheritance rights, property access, and household outcomes.
- **Post-Natal Son Preference and Inheritance Reforms**
  Examines how the reform affects child-health investments and measures of son preference.

Work in Progress

- **Marriage Bars, Women's Employment, and Intergenerational Outcomes** *(with Valerie Michelman and Barbara Biasi)*
  Studies how U.S. restrictions on the employment of married women shaped labor-force participation and longer-run outcomes for their children.

Publication

Beg, Sabrin, and Sheikh Arsalan-ul-Haque. 2024. "Policy Recommendations for Advancing the Education Sector in Pakistan." In *Striving to Meet the Sustainable Development Goals: Next Steps for Policymakers and Practitioners.* Asian Development Bank Institute. doi:10.56506/IEJD6853.

Conferences

2026: Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (forthcoming presentation).

Research Experience

University of Delaware Newark, DE
Graduate Research Assistant *Sep 2023–Present*

- Coauthor an evaluation of Punjab's land-record digitization and its effects on women's inheritance and property rights; construct and analyze primary and secondary data using staggered difference-in-differences.
- Clean and analyze baseline and endline data for Reach Up Indonesia, a village-randomized early-childhood parenting program; estimate intention-to-treat and treatment-on-the-treated effects.

The World Bank Remote
Short-Term Consultant *Jul 2024–Aug 2026*

- Conducted data cleaning, monitoring analysis, and high-frequency checks for the land-record digitization and inheritance-rights project.
- Contributed to proposal development, background research, and survey planning with investigators and field teams in Pakistan.

Center for Economic Research in Pakistan (CERP) Lahore, Pakistan
Research Associate *Sep 2022–Aug 2023*

- Programmed SurveyCTO instruments and coordinated survey design, field preparation, and data management for the Punjab land-digitization evaluation.
- Coordinated with research partners, implementation teams, and government stakeholders.

Lahore University of Management Sciences Lahore, Pakistan
Pre-Doctoral Research Associate *Aug 2021–Mar 2023*

- Supported field experiments on misinformation and digital literacy.
- Contributed to intervention design, survey development, and pre-analysis planning; analyzed project data and produced spatial maps in ArcGIS.

Teaching Experience

University of Delaware Newark, DE
Instructor of Record, Introduction to Macroeconomics (ECON 103) *Winter 2026*

Lahore University of Management Sciences Lahore, Pakistan
Adjunct Faculty, Development Economics (ECON 240) *Summer 2025*

Teaching Assistant, University of Delaware (Fall 2026): ECON 422: Econometric Methods for Causal Analysis; ECON 824: Topics in Applied Econometrics; and ECON 101 Honors Section: Introduction to Microeconomics.

Teaching Assistant, Lahore University of Management Sciences: Econometrics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Calculus II, and Introduction to Game Theory.

Technical Skills

Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS, SurveyCTO, and LaTeX.

Leadership and Service

Kaavish Lahore, Pakistan
Co-founder *Jul 2016–Present*

Founded and scaled a community-relief organization that has delivered more than 10,000 meals in underserved urban communities; led fundraising and vendor outreach.

References

Adrienne Lucas
Professor of Economics and Department Chair
University of Delaware
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University of Delaware
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